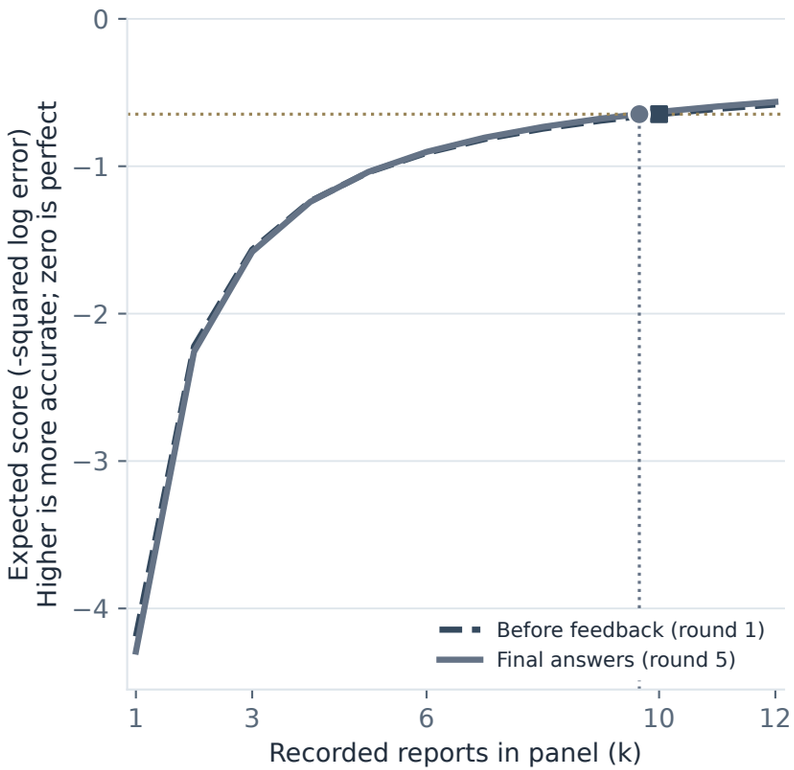
Lorenz: factual estimates before and after feedback

All dashed curves are private answers BEFORE seeing anyone else's answer to that question. Titles describe the LATER condition.
The same 144 people answered different questions under each condition; each session contained 12 people.

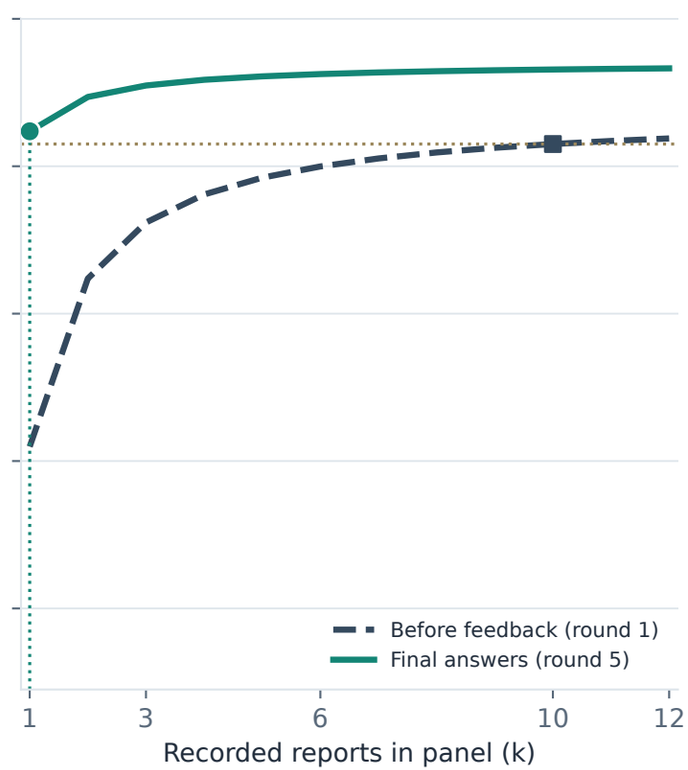
Later: no feedback



9.66 final reports match 10 initial

Whole reports: 10 | 95% interval: 6 to >12
12 sessions; 23 recorded session-question groups

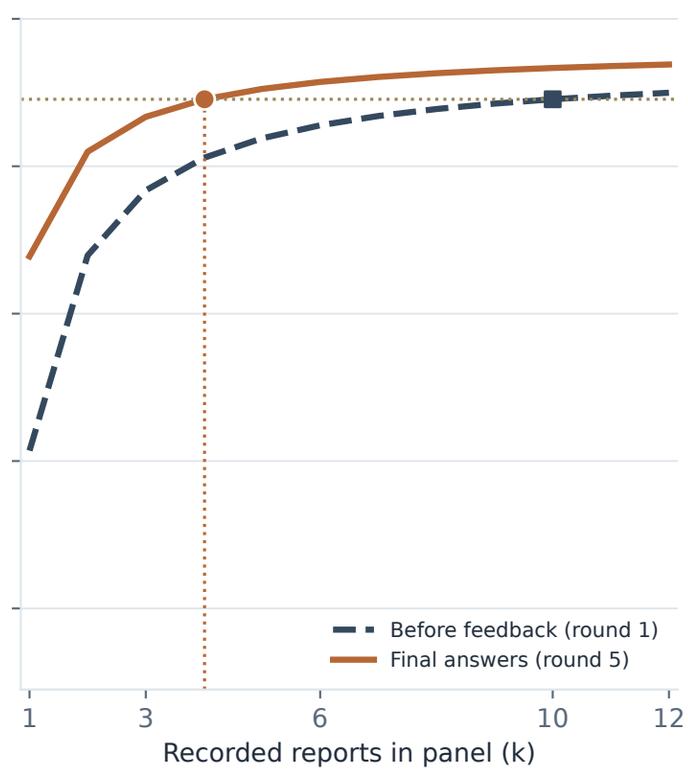
Later: see the group average



≤1 final reports reach the reference

Whole reports: 1 | 95% interval: 1 to 2
12 sessions; 24 recorded session-question groups

Later: see everyone's estimates



4.01 final reports match 10 initial

Whole reports: 5 | 95% interval: 2 to 9
12 sessions; 24 recorded session-question groups

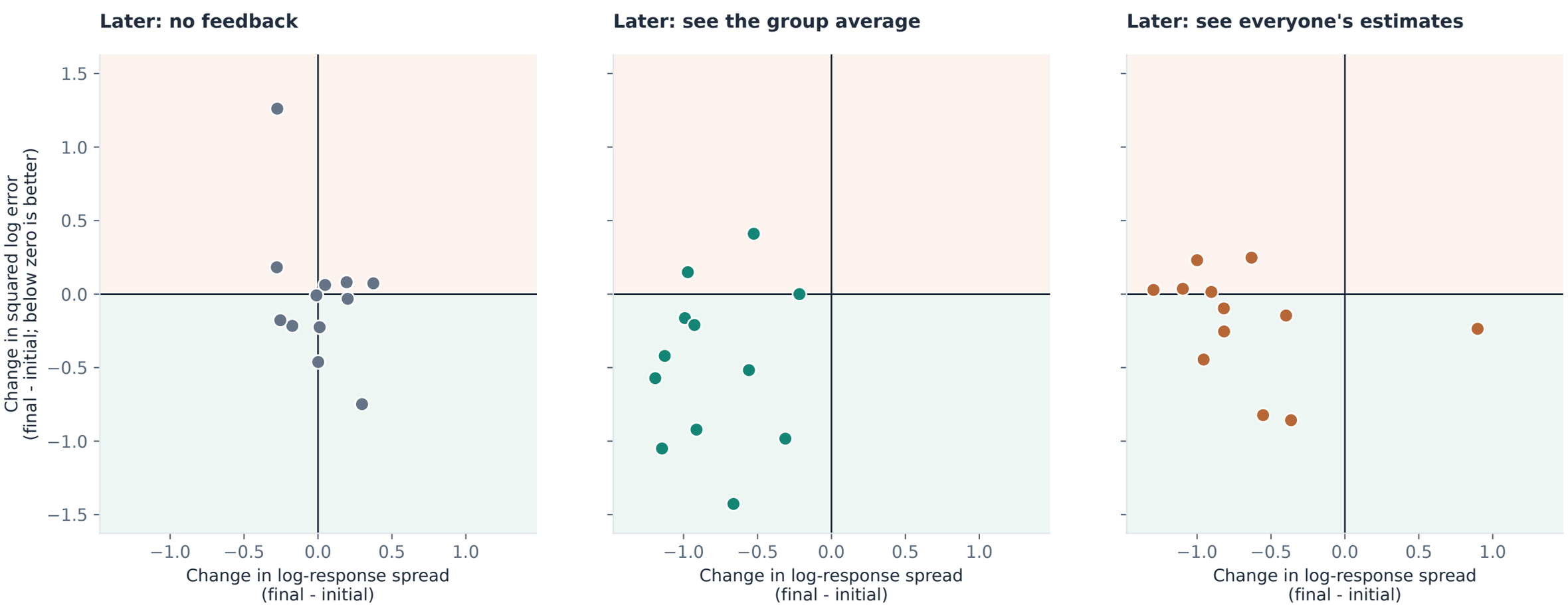
Panel estimate = geometric mean; loss = squared natural-log ratio to truth. This limits domination by extremely large numeric guesses.
Each condition has its own initial 10-report target. Intervals resample whole sessions; a boundary of <=1 does not identify a sub-person panel.

The release retains extreme entries and lacks one control question-group. These are new calculations, not the paper's cleaned effect sizes.
Social k counts reports from existing 12-person sessions, not the number of participants needed to run an experiment.

Lorenz et al. (2011) | doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1008636108 | Released data: Almaatouq et al. (2022) repository

Lorenz: convergence does not ensure better accuracy

Each dot is one session, averaging its questions under the named condition. The same sessions appear in all three panels.
Left means less disagreement after revision. Down means a more accurate full-session geometric mean.



5 of 12 sessions converged

2 converged while error increased

12 of 12 sessions converged

2 converged while error increased

11 of 12 sessions converged

5 converged while error increased

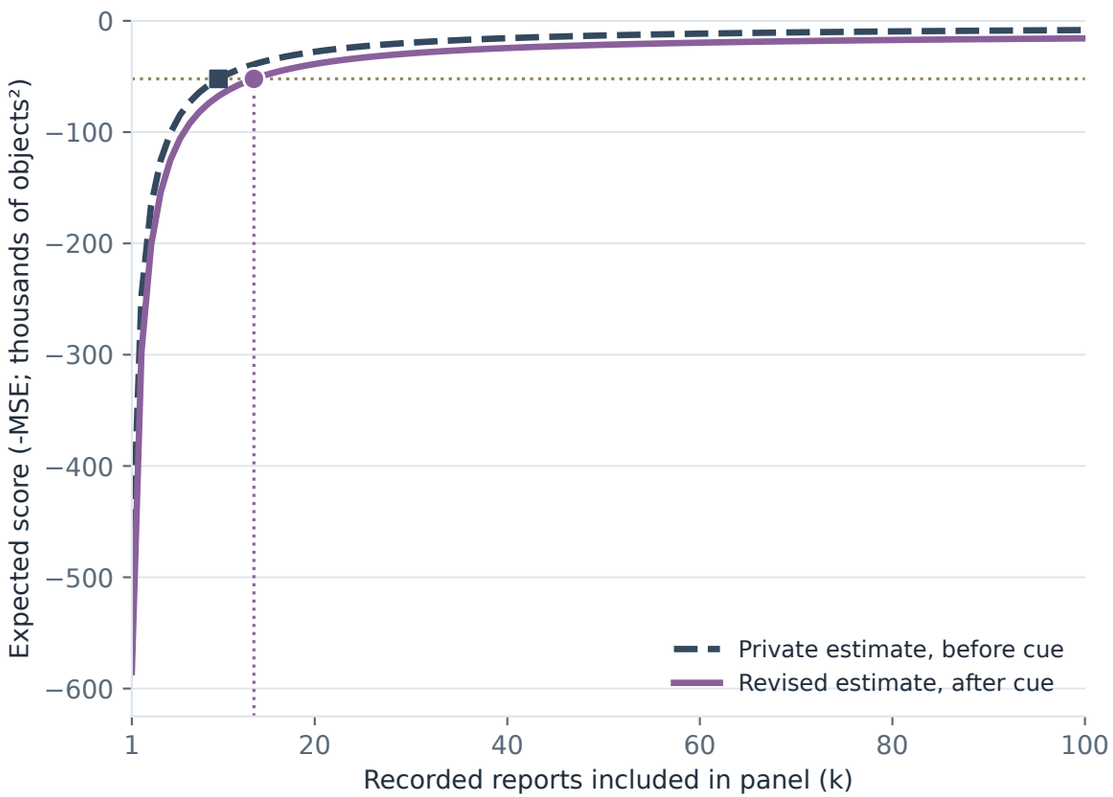
Before = round 1, before feedback about that question. After = round 5. All 12 recorded answers enter each group estimate.
Observed session changes on the released rows; no simulated trajectories, fitted response model, or additional outlier exclusions.

Lorenz et al. (2011) | doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1008636108 | Released data: Almaatouq et al. (2022) repository

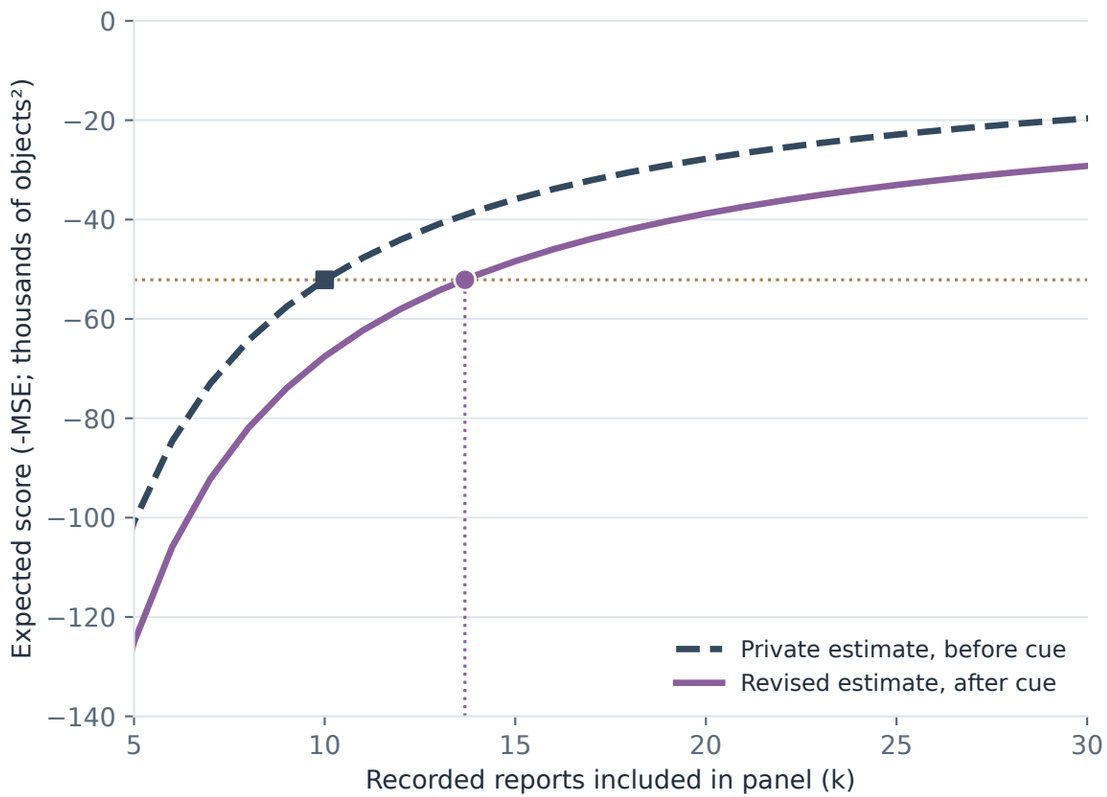
Kao: a jar estimate before and after a social cue

602 people estimated a jar containing 659 objects, then could revise after seeing a number presented as other people's average. Their guesses are real. The displayed social number was computer-generated; participants were not interacting with each other.

Full panel range



Detail around the 10-report reference



13.68 post-cue reports match 10 private reports

Whole reports: 14 | Exploratory 95% interval: 12 to 20

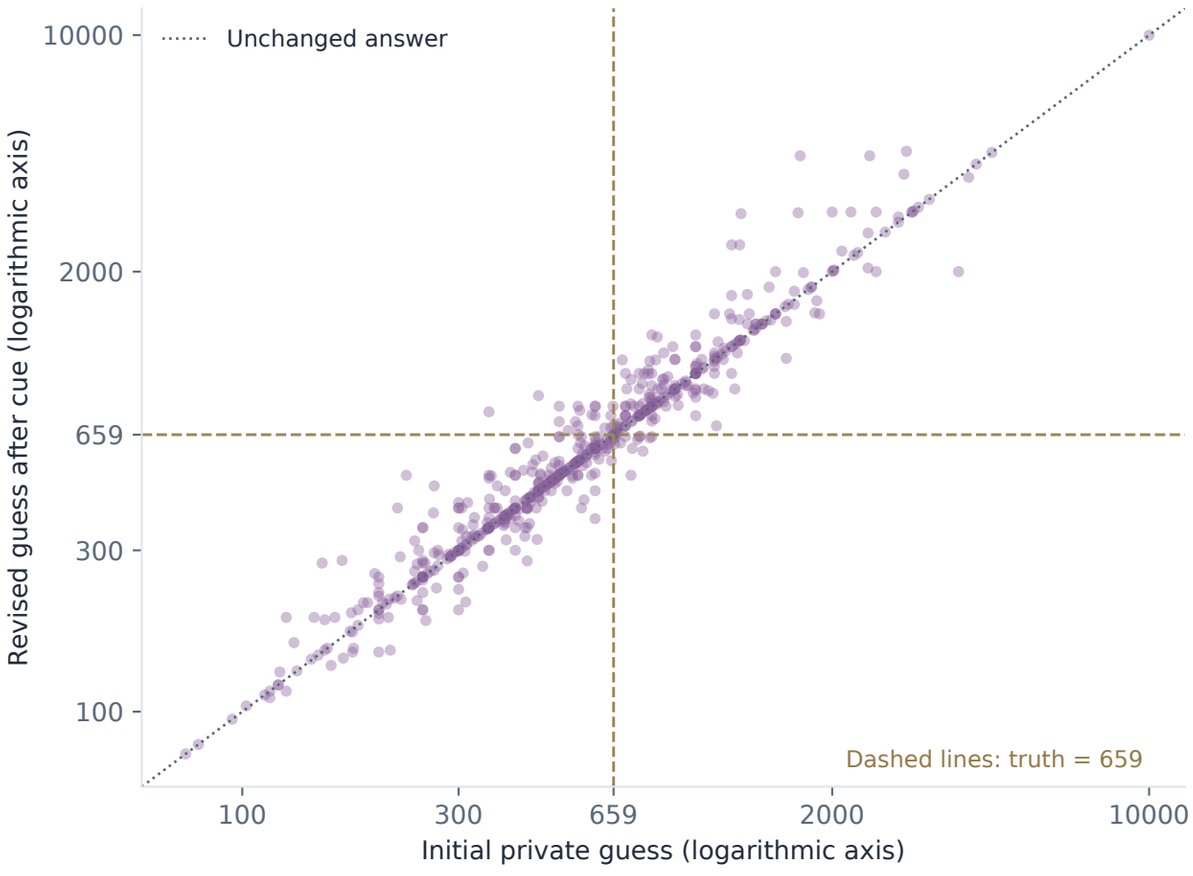
Panel estimate = arithmetic mean; score = negative expected squared error. Higher is better. No correction model is fitted.
Paired bootstrap preserves the observed mix of claimed cue sizes; the interval is conditional on this jar and this respondent sample.

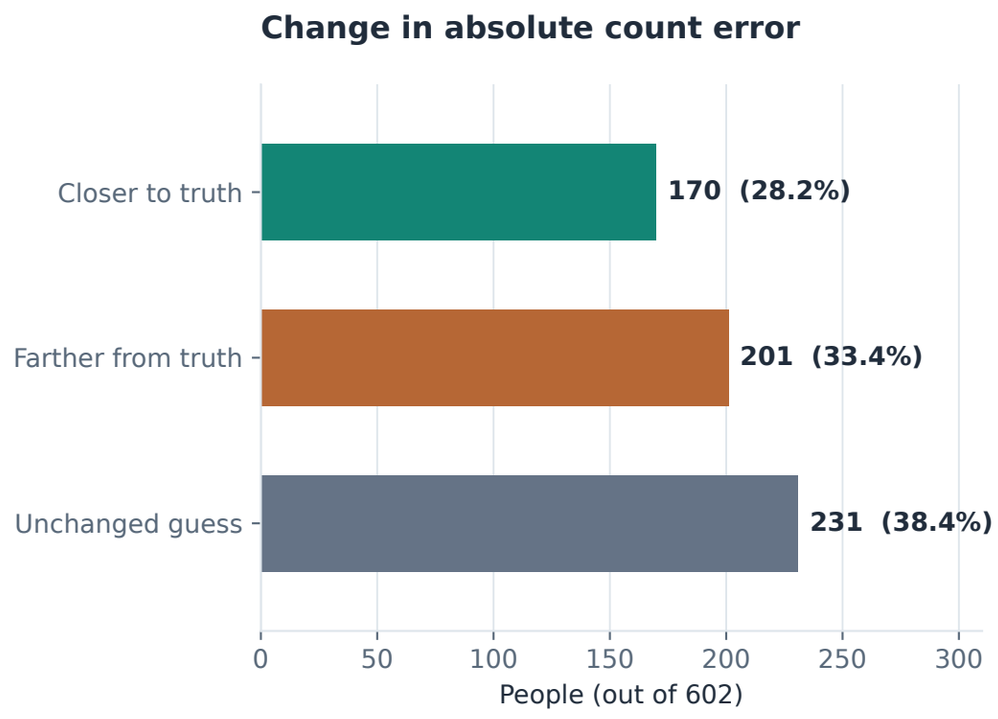
The experiment's claimed social group size N is separate from plotted panel size k. These curves average actual reports, not fictitious peers.

Kao et al. (2018) | doi.org/10.1098/rsif.2018.0130 | Data: figshare file 11094635 | 602 measured response pairs

Kao: who moved closer to the true count?

Each point pairs one person's initial private guess with their actual revised guess. The true count is 659 objects. Revision can help, hurt, or leave the answer unchanged; no simulated people or rounds are included.





Mean guess: 724 to 764
Median guess: 550 to 555

All 602 pairs are plotted, including extreme guesses; overlapping dots can represent multiple people. Counts use absolute error in objects. The log axes only make the full range of guesses visible.

The cue was experimentally constructed relative to each person's first guess. This is an observed cue-response experiment, not a live group discussion.

Kao et al. (2018) | doi.org/10.1098/rsif.2018.0130 | Data: figshare file 11094635 | 602 measured response pairs